

Guide Template

A starter for single-document beginner-guide PDFs — exercising every styled element so the stylesheet has surface area to eyeball.

Welcome

This placeholder guide is shipped with `guide-template`. It exists for two reasons:

1. The build pipeline has something to render before you replace it with your own content.
2. Every styled element in `style.css` is exercised at least once, so a styling change is easy to spot when you eyeball the rendered PDF.

Edit `guide.md` to write your own guide. Run `make` to render the PDF (output lands at `build/<slug>.pdf`). Run `make verify` to confirm the committed reference PDF (`<slug>.pdf` at the repo root) is up to date with the source — a fast, platform-independent staleness check that does no rendering.

What this section is for

This is an `h2` heading. If you change its color, weight, or margin, you'll see it when you eyeball the render; the `make verify-render` canary flags a resulting page-count or text shift.

And this is an `h3`

Used for subsections within a section. Smaller than `h2`, same family.

You can use **bold**, italic, and `inline code` in paragraphs. Lists work too:

- Unordered bullet one
- Unordered bullet two with `code`
- Unordered bullet three with **bold**

And ordered lists:

1. First step
2. Second step
3. Third step

Tables

Pipe tables get the template's table styling — blue header, alternating row tint, thin gray borders.

Element	Source markup	Renders as
Heading	# Title	<h1>
Callout	<div class="callout warn">	warning box
Exercise	<div class="exercise">	green-bordered box
Diagram	<pre class="diagram">	monospace panel

Fenced code blocks

```
$ make
$ make verify
$ make baseline
```

Code blocks render in a light gray panel with Courier-family monospace.

Blockquotes

A blockquote renders with a left border and slightly muted italic text. Use it for pull-quotes, source attributions, or short asides that don't warrant a full callout.

Callouts

The template knows three callout variants.

Warning Amber background, orange border, bold-orange "Warning" header. Use for genuinely dangerous operations.

Tip Green tint with a green left bar. Use for advisory content that isn't quite a warning.

A blue accent callout has no bold header — just a light-blue background with a blue left bar. Good for mental-model notes.

Exercise boxes

Exercises render in a green-bordered box with the title strip on top.

Exercise 1 — Hello world

Run `make` from this directory. Confirm `guide-template.pdf` appears at the repo root. You should see this exact text rendered in the green box.

ASCII diagrams

The `<pre class="diagram">` element renders ASCII art in a tan-bordered monospace panel, sized to its content.

```
guide.md --pandoc--> HTML --transforms?--> HTML' --WeasyPrint--> PDF
                                     |
                                     v
                                qpdf canonicalize
                                     |
                                     v
                                guide-template.pdf
```

Section after a forced page break

The `<div class="page-break"></div>` element forces a page break before this section. The `make verify-render` canary checks page count, so this forced break is exercised by that check too.

More content here

Any text you put on this page lives on its own physical page in the PDF, separated from the prior section by the forced break.

How verification works

There are two commands, and they answer different questions:

- `make verify` — the staleness check, and the one CI runs. It compares the content hash embedded in the committed reference PDF's footer stamp against a freshly computed hash over the source files, using a single `pdftotext` call. No build, no rendering, no platform sensitivity — milliseconds, and correct on any machine. A mismatch means someone edited source and did not re-run `make release`, so the repo ships Markdown and a PDF that disagree. It names the stale file.
- `make verify-render` — a secondary canary for the canonical host only, never wired into CI. It builds a fresh PDF and compares page count plus `pdftotext` output (with the version-stamp line excluded) against the committed reference. Because font substitution shifts line wrapping across platforms, this is meaningful only on the host the reference was rendered on; its one genuine catch is environmental drift, such as a dependency update that changes layout with no source change.

If you change source intentionally, the workflow is: `edit` → `make` → eyeball the PDF → `make release MSG="..."` to land source + refreshed reference in one commit. (Or the manual dance: `git commit source` first, then `make baseline`, then `git commit --amend` to fold the refreshed reference PDF in. Doing it in the other order produces a dirty-stamp PDF that future `verify` runs will reject.)

Guide Template

© 2026 Ross Levinsky

This guide is licensed under [Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International \(CC BY 4.0\)](#). The build tooling is licensed under [Apache License 2.0](#).